

Jakob Kasper

Ph.D. Researcher in Political Psychology

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Education

Ph.D. Communication Science, University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands 2023–2026 (Submission in October)
Supervisors: Dr. Bert N. Bakker (Communication Science) & Prof. Gijs Schumacher (Political Science)
Project: MSCA Doctoral Network "Interdisciplinary Perspectives on the Politics of Adolescence and Democracy"

M.Sc. Psychology, University of Heidelberg, Germany 2020–2023
Supervisors: Prof. Tom Gilovich & Prof. Klaus Fiedler
Thesis: *Do People Prefer to Share Political Information that Boosts their Ingroup or Derogates the Outgroup?*

Graduate Exchange Student, Cornell University, USA 2021–2022
Supervisors: Prof. David Pizarro & Prof. Tom Gilovich

B.Sc. Psychology, University of Heidelberg, Germany 2017–2020
Supervisors: Prof. Klaus Fiedler & Prof. Florian Kutzner
Thesis: *On the Role of Exploitation and Exploration Strategies in the Maintenance of Cognitive Biases*

Grants, Awards & Honors

Cornell Center for Social Sciences Research Grant (\$6,505.00, Role: Co-PI)	2025
Polarization Research Lab Successful Application Partisan Animosity Survey Time Sharing ($N = 1000$)	2024
Konrad Adenauer Foundation Academic Scholarship for Graduate Studies	2021
Baden-Württemberg Foundation Travel Scholarship	2021
University of Heidelberg Undergraduate Psychology Conference Poster Prize, 2. Rank	2021
Konrad Adenauer Foundation Academic Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies	2019
St. Hildegard School Association Award for Exemplary Social Attitudes	2017

Pre-prints and Ongoing Projects

Schumacher, G., Kasper, J., Van der Velden, M.A.C.G., Zaslove, M., Rooduijn, M. & Bakker, B.N. (in prep). *Strengthening Democracy With Interventions: A Conceptual Replication Of A Megastudy In The Netherlands*.

Kasper, J., Lee, R. T., Pennycook, G., Binnendyk, J., & Sezer, O. (in prep). *People Overestimate How Much Others Would Support Them Getting "cancelled" Over Speech*.

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., ten Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B.N. (in prep). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*.

Kasper, J., Bakker, B.N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G. (under review). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective Polarization*. doi: 10.31234/osf.io/5dfbj_v1

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B.N. (2025). *Establishing the construct and predictive validity of brief measures of affective polarization*. European Journal of Political Research. doi: 10.1111/1475-6765.70022

Laffineur, C., Kasper, J., te Brinke, L., Bakker, B. N., & Schumacher, G. (2025). *Political Interest, Activism, and Affective Polarization: Dutch Adolescents and Adults are not that Different*. Tijdschrift voor Communicatiewetenschap. doi: 10.5117/TCW2025.2.006.LAFF

Kasper, J., & Gilovich, T. (2025). *Do people prefer to share political information that boosts their ingroup or derogates the outgroup?* Journal of Experimental Psychology: General. doi: 10.1037/xge0001683

Kasper, J., & Bakker, B.N. (2025). *Alexa Bankert. When Politics Becomes Personal: The Effect of Partisan Identity on Anti-Democratic Behavior*. Public Opinion Quarterly. doi: 10.1093/poq/nfaf025

Kasper, J., Fiedler, K., Kutzner, F., & Harris, C. (2023). *On the role of exploitation and exploration strategies in the maintenance of cognitive biases: Beyond the pursuit of instrumental rewards*. Memory & Cognition. doi: 10.3758/s13421-023-01393-8

Conference Presentations & Workshops

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., ten Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B.N. (2026, February). *The Development, Level, and Malleability Adolescent Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the 24th Communication Science Conference 2026.

Kasper, J., Bakker, B.N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G. (2025, November). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective Polarization*. Talk presented at the Polarization Consortium Workshop.

Kasper, J., Bakker, B.N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G. (2025, July). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective*

Polarization. Talk presented at the Political Identities Workshop of the Amsterdam Centre for European Studies.

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., ten Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B.N. (2025, November). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Poster presented at the IP-PAD Doctoral Network Conference.

Kasper, J., Bakker, B.N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G. (2025, July). *Conceptualizing and Measuring Affective Polarization: The Role of Valence and Arousal*. Talk presented at the annual meeting of the International Society for Political Psychology.

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B.N. (2025, July). *Conceptualizing and Measuring Affective Polarization: The Role of Valence and Arousal*. Talk presented at the Dutch Political Science Conference 2025.

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B.N. (2024, September). *Putting the Affect into Affective Polarization: New Insights into Conceptualization and Measurement*. Talk presented at the German Political Psychology Meeting 2024.

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B.N. (2024, February). *Establishing the Construct and Predictive Validity of Brief Measures of Affective Polarization*. Talk presented at the 24h Communication Science Conference 2024.

Kasper, J., & Gilovich, T. (2022, May). *Do People Prefer to Share Political Information that Boosts their Ingroup or Derogates the Outgroup?* Talk presented at the 2022 Six College (Columbia, Cornell, CUNY, NYU, Princeton, Yale) Conference.

Kasper, J., Kaulhausen, F., Lob, A., & Scholten, F. (2018, October). *Too far to change? How psychological distance shapes our pro-environmental behavior*. Poster presentation at the Undergraduate Psychology Research Conference at the University of Heidelberg.

Popular Press & Dissemination

van de Wetering, J., Bakker, B.N., van den Bos, W., te Brinke, L., Green, K., van de Groep, S., **Kasper, J.**, Ma, I., Nabben, F., Schumacher, G., Sweijen, S., Toenders, Y., & Crone, E. (2026, March). *Jongerenperspectief op polarisatie. Van verdeeldheid naar verbinding*. <https://heyzine.com/flip-book>

Kasper, J. (2026, January). *Politics Doesn't Define How Most People See Themselves. The Inquisitive Mind*. <https://www.in-mind.org/blog>

Bakker, B.N., & **Kasper, J.** (2026, January). *Stop Formatting Before the Desk Reject: A Proposal for Staged Submissions. Blog of Trial and Error*. <https://doi.org/10.36850/Ofe2a79d-7165>

Bakker, B.N., **Kasper, J.**, & Schumacher, G. (2025, July). *Vanaf 16 stemmen? Jongere is er klaar voor. Algemeen Dagblad*. <https://www.ad.nl/opinie>

Kasper, J., & Gilovich, T. (2025, June). *Why Do Hostile Posts Go Viral When Most People Prefer More Positive Communication? SPSP Character & Context Blog*. <https://spsp.org/>

Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B.N., **Kasper, J.**, & Zaslove, M. (2024, December). *Alarmisme over antidemocratische jongeren is misplaatst. StukRoodVlees*. <https://stukroodvlees.nl/alarmisme-over-antidemocratische-jongeren-is-misplaatst/>

SYNC Lab & **HotPoliticsLab** (2023, December). *Fact Sheet: Hoe denken jongeren over politiek?* link to fact sheet

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Research Seminar (BA, 25 students) - Experiments, University of Amsterdam 2026
Teaching a hybrid tutorial course on experimental research methods and statistics, including the supervision of student projects and grading of individual essays and exams.

Co-Lecturer, Visualization Workshop, IP-PAD Doctoral Network 2025
Workshop on common plots in the social sciences, introduction to ggplot2, visualization best practices, and interactive coding challenge.

Guest Lecturer, Good Research Practices, University of Amsterdam 2025
Guest lectures on p-curve analysis, multiverse analysis, and causal inference in statistical control.

Research Internship Supervisor, University of Amsterdam 2025
Supervision of ten student theses, including literature review, data collection, data analysis, and report writing.

Graduate TA, Introduction to Social Psychology, Cornell University 2021–2022
Office hours for student support, creation of multiple-choice exam questions, exam instruction and administration, grading of essays.

Research Experience (Prior to the PhD)

Graduate RA, Max-Planck-Institute for Research on Collective Goods (Prof. Susanne Fiedler) 2022–2023
Literature reviews, teaching preparation, design of surveys/experiments, data analysis, coding of studies for a meta-analysis.

Graduate Researcher, Cornell University (Prof. Thomas Gilovich) 2021–2022
Independent project on polarizing political content on social media, literature review, survey and material design, data collection and analysis, lab presentations, manuscript preparation.

Graduate Researcher, Cornell University (Prof. David Pizarro) 2021–2022
Independent project on deliberate ignorance, literature review, survey and material design, data collection and analysis, lab presentations, manuscript preparation.

Graduate RA, University of Heidelberg (Prof. Klaus Fielder) 2021–2022
Independent project on pseudo-contingencies, literature review on experience sampling and racial profiling, study and survey design (SoSciSurvey), data collection and analysis.

Academic and Community Service

Reviewer: *The Journal of Politics, Political Psychology, Social Cognition, European Journal of Political Research, Journal of European Public Policy, Journal of Experimental Political Science.*

Organization of the IP-PAD Doctoral Network Conference 2025
Organization of a conference with 60 attendees, including 2 keynote talks, roundtable discussions with academics and practitioners, and 22 research posters.

HotPoliticsLab: Chairing of Weekly Speaker Series 2023-2026

PsyArXiv: Emergency Moderation of Pre-Prints 2025

Malengo: Mentoring of a student from Uganda concerning living and studying in Germany 2022-2025

PrEVENTion Heidelberg: Foundation of a non-profit organization for the prevention of depression 2019-2023

University of Heidelberg: Member of Faculty Council 2018-2019

University of Heidelberg: Member of Subject Council 2017-2021

Professional Experience

Internship - Data and Polling at Public First 2025
Data analysis (including quantitative text analysis), literature reviews, survey design, reporting and presentation for industry clients, quality control, client work support.

Junior Consultant at CF Consulting 2021
Joint moderation of digital assessment centers, preparation and implementation of online assessments, design of interviewer trainings (German/English).

Internship at PE Systemtraining 2020
Development of employee training materials, introduction of new IT tools and email system, contribution to website design.

Internship at the Psychosis Ward of the State Hospital Andernach 2020
Psychological interviews and psychoeducational group sessions.

References

Dr. Bert N. Bakker (Amsterdam School of Communication Research, University of Amsterdam)
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Prof. Gijs Schumacher (Department of Political Science, University of Amsterdam)
Role: Daily Supervisor Ph.D.
E-Mail: g.schumacher@uva.nl

Prof. Klaus Fiedler (Department of Psychology, University of Heidelberg)
Role: Thesis Supervisor (B.Sc./M.Sc.)
E-Mail: klaus.fiedler@psychologie.uni-heidelberg.de